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Erasmus+

Falken Bildungs- und Freizeitwerk Hagen e.V.

ERASMUS+ YOUTH EXCHANGE · DIGITAL HANDBOOK

Roots & Roads

Inclusion of Roma, Migrant and Refugee Youth

📅 2 – 11 November 2026

📍 Bansko, Bulgaria

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ABOUT THE PROJECT

Roots to stand on, roads to walk together

"Roots & Roads: Inclusion of Roma, Migrant and Refugee Youth" is a youth exchange bringing together 36 young people from 6 partner countries, hosted in Bansko, Bulgaria, from 2 to 11 November 2026.

The project responds to the ongoing challenges of discrimination, social exclusion and unequal participation faced by Roma, migrant and refugee youth across Europe. The exchange strengthens active citizenship, intercultural competences and anti-discrimination skills through shared learning and cooperation.

Using non-formal learning methods, participants take part in Living Library sessions, intercultural workshops, community mapping, forum theatre and creative activities, and they build real friendships across borders.

36 Young people

6 Countries

10 Days together

1 Shared road

Roots we stand on, roads we walk together.

Everyone belongs on the road. This handbook is our shared memory of the week, and it is yours to fill in.

THE PROGRAMME

Erasmus+ & Youthpass

What the programme behind this exchange actually is, and the certificate every participant takes home.

Erasmus+ Youth

Erasmus+ is the EU programme for education, training, youth and sport. Its youth strand funds learning mobility and cooperation so young people can grow, meet across borders and take part in society.

KA152 Youth Exchange

Roots & Roads is a KA152 Youth Exchange: short group mobility where young people from several countries live and learn together through non-formal activities around a shared theme.

Youthpass

Every participant receives a Youthpass, a European certificate that describes what they learned and makes non-formal learning visible for study, work and life.

Eight key competences

Youthpass is built on the eight key competences for lifelong learning, from multilingual and personal and social competence to cultural awareness and citizenship.

SIX COUNTRIES

Meet the teams

Six national teams, one shared road. Add each group photo and a short line about the team.

Add the Bulgaria group photo

Bulgaria
Change, Explore and Grow by Exchange Association · host

Write a short line about the Bulgaria team here.

Add the Türkiye group photo

Türkiye
Dadya Youth Council

Write a short line about the Türkiye team here.

Add the Greece group photo

Greece
GRO2BE

Write a short line about the Greece team here.

Add the Romania group photo

Romania
Asociatia STEM UP

Write a short line about the Romania team here.

Add the North Macedonia group photo

North Macedonia
EUROMOVE NMK

Write a short line about the North Macedonia team here.

Add the Germany group photo

Germany
Falken Bildungs- und Freizeitwerk Hagen e.V. · coordinator

Write a short line about the Germany team here.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

Participant voices

One testimonial from each country. Add a photo and the participant's own words.

Photo

Add a short testimonial from a Bulgaria participant here, in their own words.

Participant name

Bulgaria

Photo

Add a short testimonial from a Türkiye participant here, in their own words.

Participant name

Türkiye

Photo

Add a short testimonial from a Greece participant here, in their own words.

Participant name

Greece

Photo

Add a short testimonial from a Romania participant here, in their own words.

Participant name

Romania

Photo

Add a short testimonial from a North Macedonia participant here, in their own words.

Participant name

North Macedonia

Photo

Add a short testimonial from a Germany participant here, in their own words.

Participant name

Germany

WHY WE DO IT

Project objectives

01

Empower young people

Empower Roma, migrant and refugee youth to participate actively in their communities and civic life.

02

Build intercultural competences

Develop intercultural competences and strengthen understanding between young people from different cultural and social backgrounds.

03

Challenge discrimination

Promote anti-discrimination and inclusion by challenging stereotypes, prejudice and social exclusion.

04

Act locally afterwards

Equip participants with practical tools to create inclusive local actions and promote equal participation after the project.

WHAT WE DO

Activities

The non-formal activities of the week. Add a photo to each as the exchange goes on.

Add a photo

Mission Impossible

A fast team-building scavenger challenge that breaks the ice, mixes the countries and turns strangers into crews on day one.

Add a photo

Human Library

People become the "books". You borrow a person and talk one-to-one, so a real story replaces an assumption.

Add a photo

Forum Theatre

Short scenes of exclusion are played out, then the audience stops the action and steps in to rewrite what happens next.

Add a photo

Awareness Videos

Teams become film crews and shoot short campaign videos on inclusion and stereotypes for a real online audience.

Add a photo

Open Discussions

Facilitated dialogues, including a World Café, where everyone speaks and the ideas feed the joint declaration.

Add a photo

Country Realities

Each team researches and presents the real situation of Roma, migrant and refugee youth in their own country.

Add a photo

EU Directives on Inclusion, Diversity & Anti-racism

An interactive look at the rights and rules that protect people, from the EU Charter to the Racial Equality Directive.

Add a photo

Case Studies

Groups draft short, anonymised case studies from the exchange, ready to share with the SALTO Inclusion & Diversity pool.

Add a photo

Interviews with Locals

Participants meet Bansko residents and ask them about community, belonging and everyday life.

Add a photo

Cultural Nights

Every country shares its food, music, language and stories in a relaxed evening of exchange.

WHAT WE LEAVE BEHIND

Project outcomes

The lasting results of Roots & Roads.

Joint Declaration

A joint declaration on youth inclusion in the Western Balkans–EU corridor, written together by the participants.

5 Local Follow-up Actions

Five concrete inclusion actions the teams plan to run back home after the exchange.

Case Studies

Anonymised case studies prepared for the SALTO Inclusion & Diversity resource pool.

TO WAKE THE ROOM

Energizers

The games that kept the energy high between sessions. Add a photo of each in action.

Add a photo

Follow the Leader

The group copies a secret leader's moves while one person in the middle tries to guess who is leading.

Add a photo

Imaginary Bunny

A fast call-and-response game where an invisible bunny is passed around the circle, faster and faster.

Add a photo

Stuck in the Mud

A tag game: anyone tagged freezes "stuck in the mud" until a teammate crawls under to free them.

Add a photo

He-Ha-Ho

An energy circle where claps and the shouts "He! Ha! Ho!" are passed around until everyone is awake.

Add a photo

The Wind Blows

"The wind blows for everyone who..." and all who share that swap seats across the circle.

Add a photo

Broken Phone

A whispered message travels around the circle and everyone laughs at how it transforms on the way.

HOW WE WORK

Methods for inclusion & anti-racism

The non-formal approach behind every activity.

Non-formal learning

Learning by doing and reflecting, in a relaxed setting where everyone takes part and nobody is graded.

A safe space & group agreement

The group writes its own rules together so everyone can speak, disagree with respect and opt out of anything too personal.

Start from lived experience

Activities begin from real life and community, not from theory, and no one has to speak for a whole group.

Challenge the behaviour, not the person

We name exclusion and stereotypes and practise interrupting them, while keeping respect for every person in the room.

Peer learning & reflection

Daily reflection groups and Youthpass turn the experience into learning each person can name and reuse.

Creative and embodied methods

Theatre, film, mapping and storytelling let people explore inclusion with their whole selves, not only with words.

Challenge the behaviour, not the person.

We name exclusion and stereotypes out loud, and we keep respect for every single person in the room.

KNOW THE ENEMY

Stereotypes & prejudice

A short, shared language for the things this project works against.

01

What is a stereotype

A fixed, oversimplified picture of a whole group ("they are all..."). It is a mental shortcut that ignores the real, different people inside the group.

02

What is prejudice

A judgement or feeling about someone because of the group they belong to, formed before you actually know them.

03

What is discrimination

When a stereotype or prejudice turns into action: treating someone worse, leaving them out, or denying them something because of who they are.

04

How it grows

Stereotype leads to prejudice, prejudice leads to discrimination, and unchecked discrimination can harden into exclusion and even violence. It can be stopped at any step.

05

Antigypsyism & racism

Specific, long-standing prejudice against Roma, and racism against migrants and refugees, remain widespread in Europe. Naming them is the first step to ending them.

06

How to interrupt it

Meet the person behind the label, ask instead of assume, speak up as a bystander, and share real stories that break the stereotype.

The label is not the person.

Meet the person behind the stereotype, ask instead of assume, and share the real story that breaks it.

THE COORDINATOR

About Falken (FBF Hagen)

Falken Bildungs- und Freizeitwerk Hagen e.V.

Falken Bildungs- und Freizeitwerk Hagen eV.

FBF Hagen has decades of experience in non-formal youth education and community development. Its core staff and many volunteers are professionally trained youth educators and social workers.

The FBF is well integrated into Hagen's social infrastructure, working with schools, municipal agencies and migrant self-organisations. Over the years the Falken have run countless local projects, from educational workshops to cultural festivals, often with a focus on diversity and social justice.

FBF has taken part in multiple Erasmus+ initiatives, bringing international expertise back to the local community, and combines grassroots experience through its three youth centres with EU project-management competence.

www.fbf-hagen.de · info@fbf-hagen.de · @fbf_hagenprojekt · FBFHagen

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